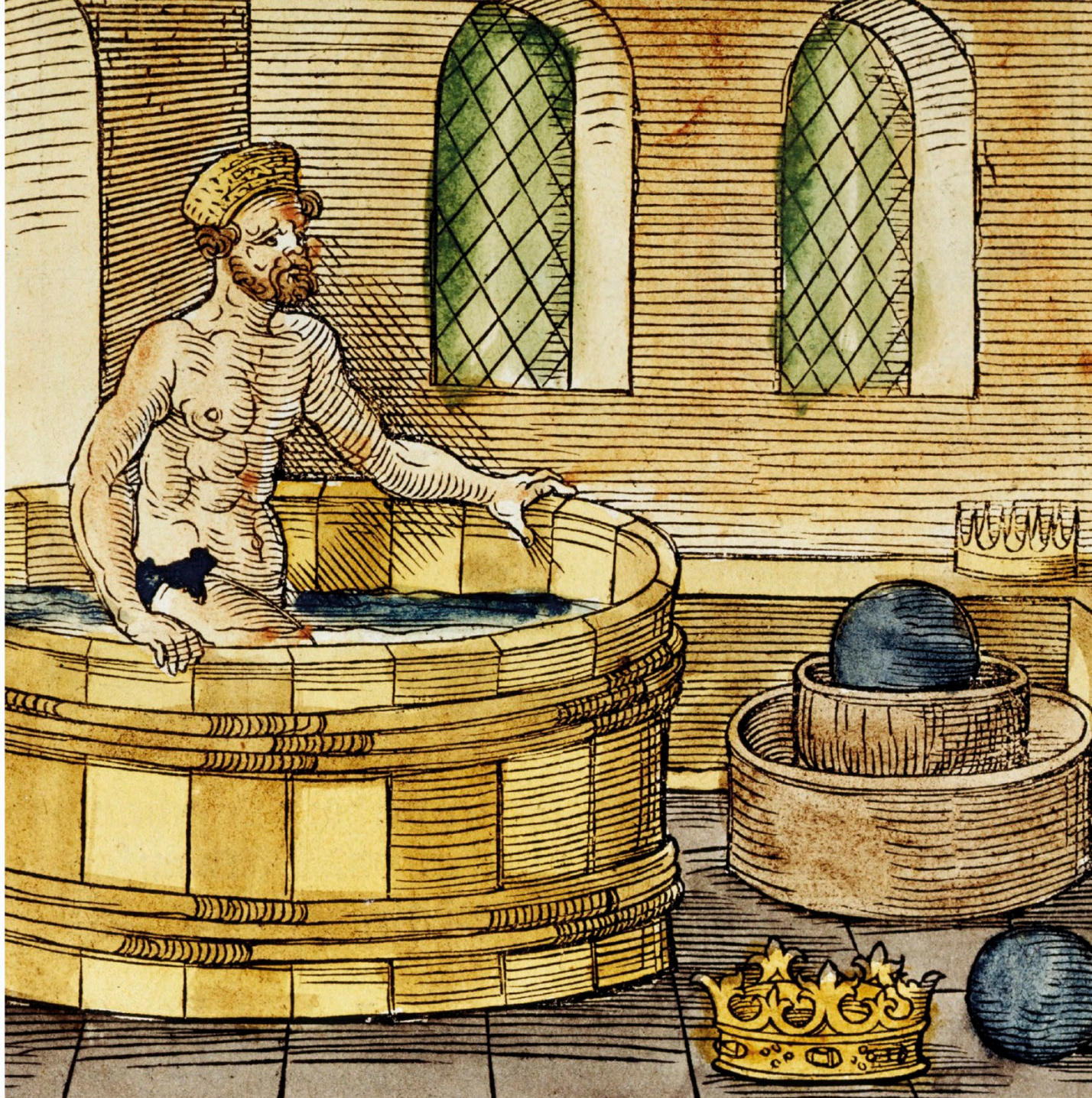




TESTING GOLD FOR A KING

The king of Syracuse suspected his new crown was not pure gold and wanted it tested. Archimedes put the crown into a tub of water, noting that it displaced a greater volume of water than a piece of gold of the same weight. This showed the crown contained other, less dense metals.

▲ EUREKA—I'VE GOT IT!

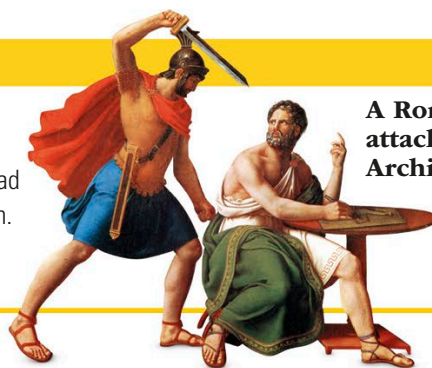
Archimedes was the first to discover that when an object is submerged, it loses weight equal to the amount of fluid it displaces. This insight is said to have come to him in his bath.

214 BCE

Roman forces begin to lay siege to Syracuse.

c. 212 BCE

The Romans capture and destroy Syracuse. They kill Archimedes, although they had been ordered not to harm him.



A Roman attacks Archimedes

75 BCE

While visiting Sicily, the famous Roman writer Cicero finds that Archimedes' elaborate tomb has fallen into disrepair, and he has it restored.